

125A Plugin Tester - User Guide

Version 0.2.0 - Windows x64 - Verified Build #61

Overview

Technical QA and release-checking tool for VST3 plug-ins on Windows. It combines custom structure, state, processing, I/O and stress tests with the official Steinberg VST3 Validator and produces TXT and JSON reports.

Usage

1. Start 125A_Plugin_Tester.exe.
2. Select the VST3 plug-in.
3. Let the complete test finish.
4. Review PASS, WARNING, FAIL and the release recommendation.

Windows warning / missing code signature

The current EXE is not signed with a publicly trusted Windows code-signing certificate. Windows may therefore show SmartScreen or Unknown publisher. That warning alone does not mean the file contains malware.

Current workaround

Only for a download from the official 125A repository: SmartScreen -> **More info** -> **Run anyway**, if offered. Alternatively right-click -> Properties -> Security -> **Unblock**. For an intentionally verified file, PowerShell can use: **Unblock-File -Path .\125A_Plugin_Tester.exe**.

Permanent fix

The proper long-term solution is an Authenticode code signature backed by a publicly trusted publisher identity, for example an OV/EV code-signing certificate or Microsoft Artifact Signing where available. The release EXE should be SHA-256 signed and RFC-3161 timestamped after the build, and the signature verified before upload. SmartScreen reputation may still need time to build for new files.

Verified reference test

The intentionally faulty BadIO VST3 fixture was correctly detected by the 125A I/O probe as **Bus arrangement - out-of-range bus index was accepted**, while the same fixture passed all 47 Steinberg Validator tests.

License

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